

Title

Protocol for Evaluating an Adherence-Focused Digital Mental Health Tool in Adults with Generalized Anxiety

Abstract

Background: Digital mental health interventions show promise for anxiety disorders, yet adherence and durability of clinical gains remain uncertain. This protocol describes a prospective evaluation of a behavioral-flexibility-focused smartphone application combined with routine care versus routine care alone. **Methods:** We will randomize 96 individuals (aged ≥ 19 years) with diagnosed generalized anxiety disorder to receive either the active intervention plus standard support or standard support alone. The intervention period will span 10 weeks, with follow-up assessment at week 15. Outcome evaluators will remain masked to treatment allocation. The primary metric will be change in standardized anxiety severity scales from baseline to intervention endpoint. Secondary measures will capture worry frequency and mood symptoms. We will also track adherence through in-app engagement metrics and assess acceptability. Data collection will occur at baseline, mid-intervention (week 5), post-intervention (week 10), and follow-up (week 15).